

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's time to discuss the next step.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs, work, and technology.
- I can compare two things or people.
- I can ask for and give opinions.

Ask your partner:

- When you have to make a decision between two different things, what do you do?
- Do you like to compare the two things? Why or why not?
- Do you ask for other people's opinions? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Janet and Miranda discuss their **competitor***.

* A "competitor" is a person or company that tries to be more successful than another.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Okay, so you do understand that there is going to be fierce competition for this bid. How do you feel about that?
- Miranda:** I believe we're ready to enter this competition to win. I reckon we have a stronger marketing record than any other company in North America.
- Janet:** That is true. But let me tell you more about our competitor. Farmani has been approached by another company which is based in the States, which is closer to Latin America.
- Miranda:** Okay, but what do we actually know about them? What's your opinion of them?
- Janet:** The way I see it, the Garcia Partners in Miami are probably our most likely competitor for this bid. They're the only company in America to have sales expertise in the Latin American market.
- Miranda:** I've heard of them. They're an e-commerce company that provides sales services via a web portal.
- Janet:** Youbuye.com! As far as I know, they provide not only consumer-to-consumer sales, but also business-to-consumer and business-to-business as well, which makes them more appealing these days.
- Miranda:** Absolutely. This means they have a clear advantage over us and they're already used to working with the Latin American market while we still have to get a foot in the door.
- Janet:** That is correct, but if you ask me, I still think we have more chances of winning this bid. Let me give you a rundown on Garcia so we can get a clearer picture of who we're dealing with.



Let's Practice!

Janet shares her opinion with Miranda.

Instructions: Match column A and column B.

COLUMN A

1. How do you feel
2. I believe
3. I reckon we
4. What do we actually
5. What's your
6. The way I
7. As far as I
8. If you ask me,

COLUMN B

- a. see it, the Garcia Partners in Miami are probably our most likely competitors on this bid.
- b. have a strong marketing record.
- c. I still think we have more chances of winning this bid.
- d. opinion of them?
- e. know about them?
- f. about that?
- g. we're ready to enter this competition.
- h. know, they provide consumer-to-consumer sales.



Let's Practice!

What can you tell me about the Garcia Partners?

Instructions: Read the list of words. Find the words in the word search below. Circle the word.

Words

1. Bid
2. Competition
3. Marketing
4. Competitor
5. Company
6. Based in
7. E-commerce
8. Web portal
9. Consumer
10. Business
11. Deal with
12. A foot in the door





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue between you and a friend in which you talk about job related issues.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Start the conversation with a greeting.
- Tell him about a job related issue.
- Ask for your friend's opinion.
- Read your dialogue with other people.
- Change roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about jobs, work and technology.

☐ ☐

I compare two things or people.

☐ ☐

I ask for and give opinions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **bid** (noun): an offer to provide services for a specific price
e.g. There are going to be many companies trying to win this bid.
- **competition** (noun): a situation in which organizations try to be more successful than other organizations
e.g. We're going to enter this competition to win.
- **based in** (expression): the place where you work or where your main business is
e.g. They are based in the States.
- **e-commerce company** (noun): a company which does its services using a computer and the Internet
e.g. They are an e-commerce company that provide sales services.
- **web portal** (noun):: a website that helps you find other websites
e.g. They do all their business via a web portal.
- **business** (noun): an organization that produces or sells goods or provides a service
e.g. They also provide business-to-consumer sales.
- **to get a foot in the door** (expression): to have an opportunity
e.g. They already work with that market while we still have to get a foot in the door.
- **to deal with** (verb): to do business with someone
e.g. We need to get a better understanding of who we're dealing with.
- **consumer** (noun): someone who buys and uses products and services
e.g. They provide consumer-to-consumer sales.





Learning Points

Comparatives

In English, it is common to describe things or people by talking about particular qualities or features that they have more of than someone or something. In order to do this, you need to use comparative adjectives. Adjectives are used to compare things.

The comparative is used to compare two people, places, ideas or things.

When comparing two things that are equal, we use the form *as + adjective + as*.

Example:

Our strategy is not as appealing as theirs.

When comparing two things that are different, we use the form *adjective + -er than ...* or, for two or more syllable adjectives, *more/less + adjective + than*.

Examples:

We have a stronger marketing record in Latin America than the competition.

Garcia Partners is more familiar with Latin American culture than Polygon.

Some adjectives have irregular comparative forms: good → better; bad → worse

Example:

We are better known and better established than the Garcia Partners.

Sometimes the comparison is implicit (you compare to something which is understood but not mentioned in the sentence).

Example:

We need to get a clearer picture of who we are dealing with.





Learning Points

Language for Asking and Giving Opinions

In the business world, it is common to give your opinion about things. However, it is advisable to ask another person about their thoughts on something before you tell them how you feel about something.

Here are some ways in which you can ask and give opinions:

Asking for Opinions	Giving Opinions
• What do you know about ... ? • What do you think of ... ? • What do you think about ... ? • How d'you feel (about ...)? • What d'you reckon (about ...)? • What's your opinion of ... ? • (What do think about) that? • What are your views on ... ? • Where do you stand (on ...)?	I believe ... I reckon ... As far as I know, ... If you ask me, ... Personally, ... To my mind, ... The way I see it, ... To be honest/frank ... To be honest/frank ...

